

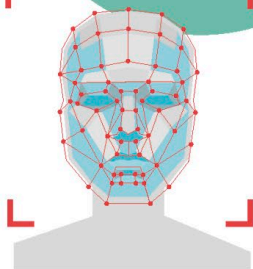
September

25

2020

Scanning faces

The government of Singapore announced plans to begin using facial recognition software to verify the identities of its citizens.



1790

Peking opera

Four opera troupes from China's Anhui province performed a style of musical theatre called Hui opera for the 80th birthday of the Qianlong Emperor, the fifth ruler of the Qing Dynasty. It developed to become Peking opera, which combines music, speech, dance, and acrobatics performed by costumed actors.



Born this day

1968 Will Smith, Black American actor and rapper. He found fame in the TV series *The Fresh Prince of Bel-Air*, before starring in a string of action and drama films.

Sprinting record

2000

At the Sydney Olympics, Indigenous Australian sprinter Cathy Freeman raced to victory in the 400 m final in 49.11 seconds, becoming the first Indigenous Australian to win an Olympic gold medal in an individual sport.



Also on this day

1956 The world's first transatlantic telephone call via cable was made between North America and the UK over 3,584 km (2,226 miles) of deep-sea cable laid at the bottom of the Atlantic Ocean.

2016 The world's largest radio telescope, called FAST, began operating in Guizhou, China. Its reflector dish, which is as large as 30 football pitches, is used to search for signs of alien life in outer space.